1. A defamatory writing, L. *libellus famosus.* Hence, the epithet being omitted, *libel* expresses the same thing. Any book, pamphlet, writing or picture, containing representations, maliciously made or published, tending to bring a person into contempt, or expose him to public hatred and derision. The communication of such defamatory writing to a single person, is considered in law a publication. It is immaterial with respect to the essence of a libel, whether the matter of it is true or false, since the provocation and not the falsity is the thing to be punished *criminally.* But in a *civil* action, a libel must appear to be false, as well as scandalous. *Blackstone.*

In a more extensive sense, any blasphemous, treasonable or immoral writing or picture made public, is a libel, and punishable by law.

2. In *the civil law,* and *in courts of admiralty,* a declaration or charge in writing exhibited in court, particularly against a ship or goods, for violating the laws of trade or of revenue.

LI'BEL, *v. t.* To defame or expose to public hatred and contempt by a writing or picture; to lampoon.

Some wicked wits have *libeled* all the fair. *Pope.*

2. To exhibit a charge against any thing in court, particularly against a ship or goods, for a violation of the laws of trade or revenue.

LI'BEL, *v. i.* To spread defamation, written or printed; with *against.* He *libels against* the peers of the realm. [*Not now in use.*]

LI'BELANT, *n.* One who libels; one who brings a libel or institutes a suit in an admiralty court.

The counsel for the *libelant,* contended they had a right to read the instructions— *Cranch, Rep.*

LI'BELED, *pp.* Defamed by a writing or picture made public.

2. Charged or declared against in an admiralty court.

LI'BELER, *n.* One who libels or defames by writing or pictures; a lampooner.

It is ignorance of ourselves which makes us the *libelers* of others. *Buckminster.*

LI'BELING, *ppr.* Defaming by a published writing or picture.

2. Exhibiting charges against in court.

LI'BELOUS, *a.* Defamatory; containing that which exposes a person to public hatred, contempt and ridicule; as a *libelous* pamphlet or picture.

LIB'ERAL, *a.* [Fr. from L. *liberalis,* from *liber,* free. See *Libel.*]

1. Of a free heart; free to give or bestow; not close or contracted; munificent; bountiful; generous; giving largely; as a *liberal* donor; the *liberal* founders of a college or hospital. It expresses less than *profuse* or *extravagant.*

2. Generous; ample; large; as a *liberal* donation; a *liberal* allowance.

3. Not selfish, narrow or contracted; catholic; enlarged; embracing other interests than one's own; as *liberal* sentiments or views; a *liberal* mind; *liberal* policy.

4. General; extensive; embracing literature and the sciences generally; as a *liberal* education. This phrase is often but not necessarily synonymous with *collegiate;* as a *collegiate* education.

5. Free; open; candid; as a *liberal* communication of thoughts.

6. Large; profuse; as a *liberal* discharge of matter by secretions or excretions.

7. Free; not literal or strict; as a *liberal* construction of law.

8. Not mean; not low in birth or mind.

9. Licentious; free to excess. *Shak.*

Liberal arts, as distinguished from *mechanical arts,* are such as depend more on the exertion of the mind than on the labor of the hands, and regard amusement, curiosity or intellectual improvement, rather than the necessity of subsistence, or manual skill. Such are grammar, rhetoric, painting, sculpture, architecture, music, &c.

Liberal has *of* before the thing bestowed, and *to* before the person or object on which any thing is bestowed; as, to be *liberal of* praise or censure; *liberal to* the poor.

LIBERAL'ITY, *n.* [L. *liberalitas;* Fr. *liberalité.* See *Liberal.*]

1. Munificence; bounty.

That *liberality* is but cast away,
Which makes us borrow what we cannot pay. *Denham.*

2. A particular act of generosity; a donation; a gratuity. In this sense, it has the plural number. A prudent man is not impoverished by his *liberalities.*

3. Largeness of mind; catholicism; that comprehensiveness of mind which includes other interests beside its own, and duly estimates in its decisions the value or importance of each. It is evidence of a noble mind to judge of men and things with *liberality.*

Many treat the gospel with indifference under the name of *liberality.* *J. M. Mason.*

4. Candor; impartiality.

LIB'ERALIZE, *v. t.* To render liberal or catholic; to enlarge; to free from narrow views or prejudices; as, to *liberalize* the mind. *Burke. Walsh.*

LIB'ERALIZED, *pp.* Freed from narrow views and prejudices; made liberal.

LIB'ERALIZING, *ppr.* Rendering liberal; divesting of narrow views and prejudices.

LIB'ERALLY, *adv.* Bountifully; freely; largely; with munificence.

If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, who giveth to all men *liberally,* and upbraideth not. James i.

2. With generous and impartial regard to other interests than our own; with enlarged views; without selfishness or meanness; as, to think or judge *liberally* of men and their actions.

3. Freely; not strictly; not literally.

LIB'ERATE, *v. t.* [L. *libero,* from *liber,* free; Fr. *liberer;* It. *liberare.*]

1. To free; to release from restraint or bondage; to set at liberty; as, to *liberate* one from duress or imprisonment; to *liberate* the mind from the shackles of prejudice.

2. To manumit; as, to *liberate* a slave.

LIB'ERATED, *pp.* Freed; released from confinement, restraint or slavery; manumitted.

LIB'ERATING, *ppr.* Delivering from restraint or slavery.

LIBERA'TION, *n.* [L. *liberatio.*] The act of delivering from restraint, confinement or slavery.

LIB'ERATOR, *n.* One who liberates or delivers.

LIBERTA'RIAN, *a.* [L. *liber,* free; *libertas,* liberty.]

Pertaining to liberty, or to the doctrine of free will, as opposed to the doctrine of necessity.

Remove from their mind *libertarian* prejudice. *Encyc.*

LIB'ERTINAGE, *n.* Libertinism, which is most used.

LIB'ERTINE, *n.* [L. *libertinus,* from *liber,* free.]

1. Among the Romans, a freedman; a person manumitted or set free from legal servitude.

2. One unconfined; one free from restraint. *Shak.*

3. A man who lives without restraint of the animal passion; one who indulges his lust without restraint; one who leads a dissolute, licentious life; a rake; a debauchee.

LIB'ERTINE, *a.* Licentious; dissolute; not under the restraint of law or religion; as *libertine* principles; a *libertine* life.

LIB'ERTINISM, *n.* State of a freedman. [*Little used.*] *Hammond.*

2. Licentiousness of opinion and practice; an unrestrained indulgence of lust; debauchery; lewdness. *Atterbury.*

LIB'ERTY, *n.* [L. *libertas,* from *liber,* free; Fr. *liberté;* It. *libertà;* Sp. *libertad.* Class Lb. No. 24. 27. 30. 31.]

1. Freedom from restraint, in a general sense, and applicable to the body, or to the will or mind. The body is at *liberty,* when not confined; the will or mind is at *liberty,* when not checked or controlled. A man enjoys *liberty,* when no physical force operates to restrain his actions or volitions.

2. *Natural liberty,* consists in the power of acting as one thinks fit, without any restraint or control, except from the laws of nature. It is a state of exemption from the control of others, and from positive laws and the institutions of social life. This liberty is abridged by the establishment of government.

3. *Civil liberty,* is the liberty of men in a state of society, or natural liberty, so far only abridged and restrained, as is necessary and expedient for the safety and interest of the society, state or nation. A restraint of natural liberty, not necessary or expedient for the public, is tyranny or oppression. Civil liberty is an exemption from the arbitrary will of others, which exemption is secured by established laws, which restrain every man from injuring or controlling another. Hence the restraints of law are essential to *civil liberty.*

The *liberty* of one depends not so much on the removal of all restraint from him, as on the due restraint upon the *liberty* of others. *Ames.*

In this sentence, the latter word *liberty* denotes *natural liberty.*

4. *Political liberty,* is sometimes used as synonymous with *civil liberty.* But it more properly designates the *liberty of a nation,* the freedom of a nation or state from all unjust abridgment of its rights and independence by another nation. Hence we

often speak of the *political liberties* of Europe, or the nations of Europe.

5. *Religious liberty*, is the free right of adopting and enjoying opinions on religious subjects, and of worshiping the Supreme Being according to the dictates of conscience, without external control.

6. *Liberty*, in metaphysics, as opposed to *necessity*, is the power of an agent to do or forbear any particular action, according to the determination or thought of the mind, by which either is preferred to the other. *Locke.*

Freedom of the will; exemption from compulsion or restraint in willing or volition.

7. Privilege; exemption; immunity enjoyed by prescription or by grant; with a plural. Thus we speak of the *liberties* of the commercial cities of Europe.

8. Leave; permission granted. The witness obtained *liberty* to leave the court.

9. A space in which one is permitted to pass without restraint, and beyond which he may not lawfully pass; with a plural; as the *liberties* of a prison.

10. Freedom of action or speech beyond the ordinary bounds of civility or decorum. Females should repel all improper *liberties*.

To take the liberty to do or say any thing, to use freedom not specially granted.

To set at liberty, to deliver from confinement; to release from restraint.

To be at liberty, to be free from restraint.

Liberty of the press, is freedom from any restriction on the power to publish books; the free power of publishing what one pleases, subject only to punishment for abusing the privilege, or publishing what is mischievous to the public or injurious to individuals. *Blackstone.*

LIB'IDINIST, *n.* One given to lewdness. *Junius.*

LIBID'INOUS, *a.* [L. *libidinosus*, from *libido*, *lubido*, lust, from *libeo*, *libet*, *lubet*, to please, it pleaseth; G. *liebe*, love; *lieben*, to love; Eng. *love*, which see. The root is *lib* or *lub*.]

Lustful; lewd; having an eager appetite for venereal pleasure. *Bentley.*

LIBID'INOUSLY, *a.* Lustfully; with lewd desire.

LIBID'INOUSNESS, *n.* The state or quality of being lustful; inordinate appetite for venereal pleasure.

LI'BRA, *n.* [L.] The balance; the seventh sign in the zodiac, which the sun enters at the autumnal equinox, in September.

LIBRA'RIAN, *n.* [L. *librarius*, with a different signification, from *liber*, bark, a book.]

1. The keeper or one who has the care of a library or collection of books.

2. One who transcribes or copies books. [*Not now used.*] *Broome.*

LI'BRARY, *n.* [L. *librarium*, *libraria*, from *liber*, a book.]

1. A collection of books belonging to a private person, or to a public institution or a company.

2. An edifice or an apartment for holding a collection of books.

LI'BRATE, *v. t.* [L. *libro*, from *libra*, a balance, a level; allied perhaps to Eng. *level*.]

To poise; to balance; to hold in equipoise.

LI'BRATE, *v. i.* To move, as a balance; to be poised.

Their parts all *librate* on too nice a beam. *Clifton.*

LIBRA'TION, *n.* The act of balancing or state of being balanced; a state of equipoise, with equal weights on both sides of a center.

2. In *astronomy*, an apparent irregularity of the moon's motions, by which it seems to librate about its axis. *Encyc.*

Libration is the balancing motion or trepidation in the firmament, whereby the declination of the sun and the latitude of the stars change from time to time. *Dict. Trev.*

3. A balancing or equipoise between extremes. *Darwin.*

LI'BRATORY, *a.* Balancing; moving like a balance, as it tends to an equipoise or level.

LICE, *plu.* of *louse*.

LICE-BANE, *n.* A plant.

LI'CENSE, *n.* [Fr. from L. *licentia*, from *liceo*, to be permitted, Ir. *leighim*, *ligim*, to allow or permit.]

1. Leave; permission; authority or liberty given to do or forbear any act. A *license* may be verbal or written; when *written*, the paper containing the authority is called a *license*. A man is not permitted to retail spirituous liquors till he has obtained a *license*.

2. Excess of liberty; exorbitant freedom; freedom abused, or used in contempt of law or decorum.

License they mean, when they cry liberty. *Milton.*

LI'CENSE, *v. t.* To permit by grant of authority; to remove legal restraint by a grant of permission; as, to *license* a man to keep an inn.

2. To authorize to act in a particular character; as, to *license* a physician or a lawyer.

3. To dismiss. [*Not in use.*] *Wotton.*

LI'CENSER, *n.* One who grants permission; a person authorized to grant permission to others; as a *licenser* of the press.

LICEN'TIATE, *n.* [from L. *licentia.*] One who has a license; as a *licentiate* in physic or medicine.

2. In *Spain*, one who has a degree; as a *licentiate* in law or divinity. The officers of justice are mostly distinguished by this title. *Encyc.*

LICEN'TIATE, *v. t.* To give license or permission. *L'Estrange.*

LICEN'TIOUS, *a.* [L. *licentiosus.*] Using license; indulging freedom to excess; unrestrained by law or morality; loose; dissolute; as a *licentious* man.

2. Exceeding the limits of law or propriety; wanton; unrestrained; as *licentious* desires. *Licentious* thoughts precede *licentious* conduct.

LICEN'TIOUSLY, *adv.* With excess of liberty; in contempt of law and morality.

LICEN'TIOUSNESS, *n.* Excessive indulgence of liberty; contempt of the just restraints of law, morality and decorum. The *licentiousness* of authors is justly condemned; the *licentiousness* of the press is punishable by law.

Law is the god of wise men; *licentiousness* is the god of fools. *Plato.*

LICH, *a.* [Sax. *lic.* See *Like.*] Like; even; equal. *Obs.* *Gower.*

LICH, *n.* [Sax. *lic* or *lice*, a body, the flesh, a dead body or corpse; *lichama*, a living body; hence *lichwake*, watching with the dead; *Lichfield*, the field of dead bodies; Goth. *leik*, the flesh, a body; *leikan*, to please, Sax. *licean*; Goth. *leiks*, like; G. *gleich*, D. *lyk* and *gelyk*, like; G. *leiche*, a dead body, D. *lyk*; Heb. חלק chalak, smooth; Ar. خلق chalaka, to shave, to make smooth; خلق galaka, to measure, to form, to create, to make smooth and equable, to be beautiful; derivatives, creature, man, people. We see the radical sense is smooth, or rather to make even, equal, smooth; hence like, likeness, and a body. We have here an instance of the radical sense of *man* and *body*, almost exactly analogous to that of *Adam*, from דמה to make equal, to be like.]

LICH'EN, *n.* [L. from Gr. λειχην.] In *botany*, the name for an extensive division of cryptogamian plants, constituting a genus in the order of Algæ, in the Linnean system, but now forming a distinct natural order. They appear in the form of thin flat crusts, covering rocks and the bark of trees, or in foliaceous expansions, or branched like a shrub in miniature, or sometimes only as a gelatinous mass, or a powdery substance. They are called rock moss and tree moss, and some of the liverworts are of this order. They also include the Iceland moss and the reindeer moss; but they are entirely distinct from the true mosses *(Musci.)* *Ed. Encyc.*

2. In *surgery*, a species of impetigo, appearing in the form of a red, dry, rough, and somewhat prurient spot, that gives off small furfuraceous scales. *Hooper.*

LICHENOGRAPH'IC, LICHENOGRAPH'ICAL, *a.* Pertaining to lichenography.

LICHENOG'RAPHIST, *n.* One who describes the lichens.

LICHENOG'RAPHY, *n.* [*lichen* and γραφω, to write.]

A description of the vegetables called lichens; the science which illustrates the natural history of the lichens. *Acharius.*

LIC'IT, *a.* [L. *licitus.*] Lawful.

LIC'ITLY, *adv.* Lawfully.

LIC'ITNESS, *n.* Lawfulness.

LICK, *v. t.* [Sax. *liccian*; Goth. *laigwan*; G. *lecken*, *schlecken*; D. *likken*; Dan. *likker*, *slikker*; Sw. *slekia*, *slikia*; Fr. *lecher*; It. *leccare*; Ir. *leagaim*, *lighim*; Russ. *lokayu*, *liju*; L. *lingo*; Gr. λειχω. Class Lg. No. 12. 18. See *Like* and *Sleek*.]

1. To pass or draw the tongue over the surface; as, a dog *licks* a wound. *Temple.*

2. To lap; to take in by the tongue; as, a dog or cat *licks* milk. 1 Kings xxi.

To lick up, to devour; to consume entirely.

Now shall this company *lick up* all that are round about us, as an ox *licketh up* the grass of the field. Numb. xxii.

To lick the dust, to be slain; to perish in battle.

His enemies shall *lick the dust*. Ps. lxxii.